

Year 3 Science: Day, Night and Shadows

Explore how Earth, the Sun and light cause day, night and shadows.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Learning Intention

I can explain day, night and shadows using the Sun and Earth.

Success Criteria

I can identify light sources, explain shadows, and describe day/night changes.

A. Quick Questions

Circle the correct answer.

1. The Sun is a light source / shadow.
2. Shadows form when light is blocked / copied.
3. Day and night happen because Earth moves / sleeps.

B. Fill the Blanks

Use these words: Sun, shadow, Earth, light

1. The _____ gives us daylight.
2. A _____ forms when an object blocks light.
3. The _____ rotates once each day.
4. We need _____ to see clearly.

C. Explain

1. Why is it dark at night?

2. Why does a tree make a shadow?

3. What might happen to a shadow during the day?

D. True or False

1. The Sun moves around Earth each day. ____
2. Shadows need light. ____
3. A clear object may make a faint shadow. ____
4. Night happens everywhere at the same time. ____

E. Challenge

Draw a ball, the Sun and its shadow. Label: Sun, object, shadow.

Answer Key: Day, Night and Shadows

Teacher/Parent Guide - Year 3 Science

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Complete Answer Key

A. 1 light source, 2 blocked, 3 Earth moves/rotates.

B. 1 Sun, 2 shadow, 3 Earth, 4 light.

C. 1 It is dark because our side of Earth is turned away from the Sun. 2 The tree blocks some of the Sun's light. 3 Shadows can change length and direction as the Sun appears to move across the sky.

D. 1 False, 2 True, 3 True, 4 False.

E. Diagram should show light from the Sun, object blocking light, and a shadow on the opposite side.

Parent/Teacher Tip: Try this outside with a pencil or toy. Mark the shadow in the morning and afternoon.